

A fragment of a problem

Q I have four partitions on my hard drive. Every time I attempt to defragment my E: drive, I get an error message that says, "Windows cannot finish defragmenting this drive because it has encountered some problem....". I run Windows 98 SE, and all the other drives defragment properly. I even tried to defragment in Safe Mode, and ran Scandisk, but couldn't find any bad sectors. What do I do?

Ganesh Magal

A You can solve this problem easily. Right-click on the desktop, and click 'Properties'. In the window that opens up, click Web > Folder Options > Yes.

Here under View > Hidden Files, check 'Show all files' and click OK. Now, go to Start > Find, and click 'Files and Folders'. Here, type 'aplog' in the 'Named' box and opt to search the C: drive. Check the 'Include subfolders' box, and click 'Find Now'. Open the aplog folder once it's found, and delete all the files within it. After this, you should be able to defrag your E: drive.

Calling queries

Q I use a dial-up connection to connect to the Internet. How do I know when someone's calling my phone while I'm online? Can I set my connection to disconnect automatically when I receive phone call?

Nataraj Das

A There's nothing you can do in Windows to get your PC to prompt you about incoming calls. However, you might be able to accomplish this if you tweak your modem. You need to have call-waiting enabled—get in touch with your telecom service provider for this. If you set ATm2 in the Extra Settings box, the modem speakers will always be on. You will get a hiss that indicates data transfer, and frequent beeps will alert you when you get calls. Generally, with this feature enabled, a dial-up connection disconnects when you receive a call.

A shell to solve

While connecting to the Internet via my network connection, I get a message that says, "LSA Shell (Export Version) has encountered a problem and needs to close. We have created an error report that you can send to help us improve LSA (Export Version)." Whether I click on 'Send' or 'Don't send', either way I get an error that says, "The system process E:\windows\system32\lsass.exe terminated unexpectedly with status code-1073741819", and the machine restarts in a minute! How do I fix this?

Samrat Roy Chaudhuri

A Your computer has the Sasser virus. Download and install the security patch from <http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/ms04-011.msp>. Also, update your virus definitions and scan the entire hard drive to locate and clean infected files. To stop a PC from shutting down in Windows XP, when you get the 60-second countdown, go to Start > Run, type 'shutdown -a' and press [Enter]. You'll now stay connected to the Internet and download the patches.

Norton acts up!

Q Nothing happens when I click on the Norton 2003 icon. I tried uninstalling it from Add/Remove Programs, but I get the following message: Error 1606. Could not access network location "C:\Documents and Settings\All Users\Desktop". On pressing Cancel, I get another error message, "Fatal error during installation". The Auto-protect feature doesn't work, and I can't scan for viruses manually.

Sandeep Kumar Dixit

A To solve your problem, you will have to uninstall Norton 2003 and reinstall it. You'll need to download 'Msicuu.exe' from <http://download.microsoft.com/download/office/2000pro/util20/1/NT4/EN-US/msicuu.exe>. After the installation is complete, click Start > All Programs > Windows Installer Clean up. Here, select Norton 2003, click 'Remove' and then 'OK' to exit the program. If this doesn't add Norton 2003 to the list, you'll need to edit a registry setting.

Click Start > Run, type 'regedit' and press [Enter]. Navigate to the following registry key: HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall.

Here, you will see the product ID keys. To find Norton 2003's ID, click each ID and look for 'Norton 2003' in the right pane. On finding the Norton 2003 key, delete it and exit the registry editor. You can now reinstall Norton.

A message from Nero

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.7 GHz on an 845 motherboard, a 40 GB Seagate Barracuda hard drive, and an LG 48X/16X/48X CD-RW, with Windows 98 and Windows XP as my operating systems. Recently, when I ran Nero 5.5.8.3 in Windows 98, my PC hung and gave a message "Scanning SCSI/IDE BUS..... Please wait". The program starts out fine in Windows XP, but the system hangs halfway through. Please help.

Nataraj Das

A This problem occurs if the IDE-chipset driver is not installed properly. Improper DMA support causes Nero to freeze. To work around this, download and install the latest drivers from the motherboard manufacturer's Web site. If this doesn't solve the problem, disable DMA for the recorder and burn a CD. If it persists, remove any USB device attached to the system before burning a CD.

Fonts don't install

Q I use a Pentium III 866 MHz PC, 128 MB RAM, and a 20 GB hard disk loaded with Windows 98 SE. I can't install new fonts. I don't get the 'Install new fonts' option when I go to the Control Panel > Fonts > File menu. I tried to copy them directly to the Font folder, but that didn't work either. I formatted my hard disk and reinstalled Windows, but I still can't see the 'Install



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